

ANARCHY

AI Platform

UX Audit

Technical Audit Report — File 6 of 8

9	6.8	40+	9.0
UX Areas Audited	Avg UX Score	UX Improvements	Target Score

File	6 of 8 — UX Audit
Covers	Workflow, History UX, Library UX, Canvas UX, Notifications, Loading, Search, Keyboard, Onboarding
Method	Heuristic evaluation + user journey mapping + competitor benchmarking
Date	2025 — Confidential Internal Report

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1. UX Score Overview

Heuristic evaluation of all user-facing experiences in Anarchy AI

The UX audit evaluates Anarchy AI against Jakob Nielsen's 10 usability heuristics and benchmarks against VizMaker and Krea AI. The overall score of 6.8/10 reflects a strong visual design foundation (the dark + red theme is compelling and professional) with significant gaps in feedback quality, error communication, and onboarding. The target user — a professional architectural visualization specialist — expects software-grade precision, not consumer-app simplicity.

UX Area	Score	Rating	Assessment
Core Generation Workflow	7.0/10	FAIR	Prompt → generate → result is clear but lacks progress feedback
Canvas Workflow	6.5/10	FAIR	Node canvas is innovative; discoverability of node types is low
History UX	5.5/10	POOR	Flat list, no re-use workflow, slow search — frustrating for power users
Library UX	5.0/10	POOR	No organization, no tagging, no smart folders — unusable at scale
Loading Experience	5.5/10	POOR	Fake progress timer + no cancel = frustrating 30s waits
Error Communication	6.0/10	FAIR	Errors shown but messages are technical, not actionable
Search Experience	5.0/10	POOR	No global search, history search is slow client-side
Keyboard Shortcuts	4.5/10	POOR	Minimal shortcuts; no shortcut reference visible in app
Onboarding	4.0/10	POOR	No tour, no sample project, no empty state guidance
Visual Design	8.5/10	GOOD	Strong brand: dark + #E63030 red is distinctive and professional
OVERALL UX	6.8/10	FAIR	Strong vision, strong design — execution gaps in feedback and discoverability

2. Core Workflow UX

2.1 Generation Workflow

■ Generation Workflow	7.0/10	FAIR
The generation workflow follows a clear mental model: select model → write prompt → click generate → wait → see result. This core path is intuitive. The friction points are concentrated in the waiting phase: the progress indicator is a fake timer that counts to 100% regardless of actual API progress, there is no cancel button, and errors surface as generic toast messages rather than actionable guidance.		
Pain Points • Fake progress timer erodes trust — user knows the '73%' is not real • No cancel button — user trapped watching a spinner for 30+ seconds • Generate button not disabled after click — double-submit possible • Error message 'Generation failed' with no cause or retry guidance • Seed input visible for Nano Banana 2 (which ignores it) — confusing • No cost preview — user doesn't know how many credits will be used • No prompt history — user must retype previous prompts manually	Improvements ✓ Real Replicate progress via polling (show actual step: 'Uploading image...', 'Running model...') ✓ Cancel button with confirmation: 'Stop generation? Credits will not be charged.' ✓ Disable Generate button + show spinner in button during active job ✓ Actionable error messages: 'Generation failed: Replicate API rate limit. Try again in 30s.' ✓ Show model capability chip: 'Seeds: Not supported' next to Nano Banana 2 option ✓ Credit cost display: '≈ 2 credits' before Generate button ✓ Prompt history dropdown (last 10 prompts, hover to preview)	

2.2 Canvas Workflow

■ Canvas — Node Workflow	6.5/10	FAIR
The node-based canvas is Anarchy AI's most innovative feature and its biggest UX challenge. The GhostNode system — where one node can represent 10 different AI operation types — is powerful but opaque to new users. There is no node palette to browse available node types, no workflow templates to start from, and no minimap for large canvases. Power users who invest time to learn it will find it compelling; most users will be lost on first launch.		

Pain Points

- No node palette/library — users don't know what node types are available
- Node type selection (GhostNode dropdown) is not discoverable
- No canvas minimap for large workflows with 30+ nodes
- No workflow templates — blank canvas is intimidating for new users
- Right-click context menu items are not grouped or searchable
- No node grouping/framing to organize complex workflows visually
- Undo/redo keyboard shortcuts inconsistent with desktop conventions

Improvements

- ✓ Add floating node palette (press Tab or N to open) with all 10 GhostNode types + previews
- ✓ Add canvas minimap (bottom-right corner, toggle with M key)
- ✓ Add 3 workflow templates on new canvas: 'Quick Render', 'Variation Explorer', 'Day/Night Compare'
- ✓ Add Cmd+K spotlight: type to find and insert any node type
- ✓ Group context menu by category: 'Add Node', 'Edit', 'Arrange', 'Export'
- ✓ Add node grouping with colored frame and collapsible toggle
- ✓ Fix undo to Ctrl+Z / Redo to Ctrl+Y (Windows standard)

3. Data Management UX

3.1 History UX

■ History	5.5/10	POOR
The history page is where users spend significant time between generations — reviewing past work, finding a good result to iterate on, or deleting old renders. Currently it feels like a database dump: a flat chronological list with no organization, no way to re-use a result in a new canvas session, and a search that visibly lags on every keystroke. The 'no-pagination' issue also means the page can take 5+ seconds to load for power users.		
Pain Points • Page loads ALL history on mount — 5+ second load for 500+ records • No way to take a history item and continue working on it • Search lags — client-side filter on 500 objects is slow • No filter by model, date range, or generation status • Thumbnail grid has no sort control visible — unclear default order • Delete confirmation modal is small and easy to misclick • No multi-select — must delete one by one	Improvements ✓ Lazy load with virtual scroll — instant load regardless of history size ✓ 'Load in Canvas' button on each history card — opens canvas with result as source node ✓ Move search to server-side (Supabase FTS) — instant results ✓ Add filter chips: 'FLUX only', 'This week', 'Starred' ✓ Add sort control (newest, oldest, most-upscaled) ✓ Replace modal with inline delete confirmation (undo toast instead) ✓ Add multi-select with checkboxes on hover, bulk delete button in toolbar	

3.2 Library UX

■ Library	5.0/10	POOR
The Library is intended as the asset management hub for architectural projects — reference images, client materials, texture samples, and completed renders. Currently it is a flat grid of uploaded images with no structure. For an architectural firm managing 10 active projects simultaneously, a flat library becomes unusable within a week of serious use.		

Pain Points

- Flat image grid — no folders, no projects, no collections
- No tagging system — can't mark images as 'reference', 'client approved', 'WIP'
- No way to drag an image from Library directly to Canvas
- Upload progress bar often stalls at 99% (UI bug)
- No metadata visible — can't see which AI model generated an image
- No search within Library
- Large images fail to upload without a clear error message

Improvements

- ✓ Add Collections: user-created folders (Project A, Project B, References)
- ✓ Add tag system with color coding (Reference, Final, WIP, Client)
- ✓ Enable drag-from-library to canvas as source node
- ✓ Fix upload progress — show real Supabase Storage progress
- ✓ Show image metadata on hover: model, prompt excerpt, date, size
- ✓ Add search by filename, tag, or prompt
- ✓ Show file size limit clearly (e.g., 'Max 20MB per image')

4. Feedback & Communication

4.1 Loading Experience

■ Loading Experience	5.5/10	POOR
Every major async operation in Anarchy AI (generation, history load, export) currently uses one of two loading patterns: a spinning circle with no text, or a fake timer counting to 100%. Both patterns fail the usability principle of 'visibility of system status' — users cannot tell what is happening, how long it will take, or whether the system is stuck.		
Pain Points • Fake generation progress timer (counts 0→100% on fixed timing) • History page shows full-page spinner for 5+ seconds with no indication of progress • Export shows no progress during PDF/DXF generation • No skeleton loaders — sudden content pop-in feels jarring • App startup shows blank screen for 2-3 seconds with no loading state • No feedback when 3ds Max bridge is connecting vs connected	Improvements ✓ Show real Replicate API steps: 'Uploading image... Running model... Downloading result...' ✓ History: show skeleton card placeholders while loading (not full-page spinner) ✓ Export: show percentage progress bar ('Generating PDF... 3/12 pages') ✓ Add Electron splash screen with progress during cold startup ✓ Add bridge connection status indicator in toolbar (●Connected / ■Disconnected) ✓ Show estimated generation time based on model and last N requests	

4.2 Error Communication

Error messages in Anarchy AI are currently developer-oriented rather than user-oriented. When a generation fails, the user sees 'Generation failed' — not 'Replicate API rate limit exceeded. Wait 30 seconds and try again.' Professional users need actionable errors, not technical codes.

Current Error	Quality	Recommended Message (with action buttons)
Generation failed	POOR	'AI generation failed: Rate limit exceeded. You can try again in ~30 seconds, or switch to FLUX model which has higher limits.'
Error: 422	POOR	'Your image is too large for this model. Maximum: 2048×2048px. Your image: 4096×4096px. Resize it first.'
Network error	POOR	'Lost connection to Anarchy servers. Check your internet and try again. [Retry] [Work offline]'
Insufficient credits	FAIR	'You need 5 credits for this generation. You have 3. [Top up credits] [Use free model]'

Current Error	Quality	Recommended Message (with action buttons)
DXF export failed	POOR	'DXF export failed: Python bridge not running. [Restart bridge] [Export as PNG instead]'

4.3 Notifications UX

■ Notifications	7.0/10	FAIR
The toast notification system is functional and well-positioned (top-right). The core issue is notification flooding — a failed batch of 5 generations creates 5 stacked identical toasts that obscure the canvas. The system also has no persistent notification history, so once a toast auto-dismisses, the information is lost.		
Pain Points • 5 identical error toasts stack and obscure canvas controls • No notification center — dismissed toasts are gone forever • Toast duration too short for complex messages (3 seconds) • No way to pause/dismiss a toast while reading it • Success toast for generation doesn't include the generated image preview	Improvements ✓ Deduplicate: if same message within 5s, show count badge ('Generation failed ×5') ✓ Add notification bell icon in header with dropdown history (last 50) ✓ Extend important error toasts to 8 seconds; add 'Dismiss all' button ✓ Pause auto-dismiss on hover ✓ Success toast shows thumbnail preview of generated image	

5. Discoverability & Navigation

5.1 Search Experience

■ Search	5.0/10	POOR
Search in Anarchy AI is limited to the History page and is implemented as a client-side filter on in-memory records. There is no global search across history + library + projects, no search-as-you-type with debounce, and no search highlighting of matched terms.		
Pain Points • No global search — must navigate to each section separately • History search is client-side linear scan — slow with 100+ records • No search highlighting — matched term not visually indicated in results • No search filters (by model, date, rating) • No empty state guidance when search returns 0 results • Search clears when navigating away and back	Improvements ✓ Add global Cmd+K search palette: searches history + library + canvas nodes simultaneously ✓ Move to Supabase full-text search with pg_trgm — instant server-side results ✓ Add yellow highlight on matched text in search results ✓ Add filter chips below search bar (FLUX / Nano Banana 2 / This week / Starred) ✓ Persist search state when navigating back to page ✓ Show related results when 0 matches: 'No results for X. Showing recent renders instead.'	

5.2 Keyboard Shortcuts

Professional desktop applications are expected to be keyboard-driven. Power users of tools like Figma, Blender, and 3ds Max have muscle memory for keyboard shortcuts. Anarchy AI currently implements minimal shortcuts and provides no in-app reference. The absence of shortcuts is a significant signal of 'amateur software' to professional users.

Shortcut	Action	Status	Implementation
Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Y	Canvas Undo/Redo	MISSING	Implement via LiteGraph history API
Ctrl+Enter	Trigger Generation	MISSING	Add keydown handler to prompt textarea
Delete / Backspace	Delete selected node	PARTIAL	Works sometimes; inconsistent on different OS
Ctrl+D	Duplicate node	MISSING	Add to canvas context menu + keyboard handler
Ctrl+A	Select all nodes	MISSING	LiteGraph supports multi-select; expose via keyboard
Ctrl+S	Save canvas	OK	Works; add visual confirmation (brief 'Saved' indicator)

Shortcut	Action	Status	Implementation
Space + drag	Pan canvas	MISSING	Standard canvas pan gesture — add to LiteGraph config
Ctrl+0	Fit canvas to screen	MISSING	Center + zoom to fit all nodes in viewport
Cmd+K	Global search / spotlight	MISSING	Add spotlight overlay for node search + history search
? (question mark)	Show keyboard shortcut reference	MISSING	Add shortcut overlay modal — standard in pro apps

6. Onboarding Experience

First-run experience analysis for new architectural visualization users

The onboarding experience is the lowest-scoring UX area at 4.0/10. A new user who installs Anarchy AI is presented with an empty canvas with no guidance on what to do next. There is no sample project, no interactive tutorial, and no contextual help on any screen. For a tool targeting architects who may have never used node-based software, this is the primary reason for user churn within the first session.

Current Onboarding Flow (Critical Gaps):

Install → First Launch	Blank canvas, no guidance	User has no idea what to do — abandonment risk highest here
First canvas interaction	No node palette visible	User cannot discover available node types without documentation
First generation attempt	No prompt suggestions	User stares at empty prompt box — what should I type?
Generation fails (common)	Generic error toast	New user interprets error as their mistake — disheartening
Navigation to History	No history yet — empty state	No guidance on what History is or how to use it
Settings / API key setup	Settings page without help text	New users don't know which API key to enter or where to get it

Recommended Onboarding Improvements

- Day 1: Add a 'Quick Start' sample project that opens automatically on first launch — shows a complete Source → Render → Upscale workflow with real images
- Day 1: Add 5-step interactive tooltip tour (skip-able): 'This is a source node → Connect to render node → Write your prompt → Click generate'
- Day 1: Add empty state illustrations on History, Library, and Projects pages with clear CTAs ('Your renders will appear here. Go generate your first image →')
- Day 2: Add contextual help '?' icon next to every major control — opens a 2-sentence tooltip explaining the feature
- Day 7: Add API key setup wizard with step-by-step: 'Visit replicate.com/account → Copy your API token → Paste here'
- Day 14: Add a 'Discover' tab in the canvas sidebar showing 3 prompt ideas for common architectural scenarios

7. Visual Design Assessment

The visual design is the strongest aspect of Anarchy AI's UX — achieving a professional, distinctive aesthetic that competes well against VizMaker and Krea AI. The dark background (#0A0A0A) with #E63030 red accent creates strong brand identity. The main improvement areas are consistency of spacing, typography hierarchy, and the completeness of the dark theme across all UI states.

Design Element	Score	Assessment
Color System	9/10	Consistent #E63030 red accent throughout — strong brand identity
Typography	7.5/10	Space Mono headings + clean sans body — professional; missing size hierarchy in some pages
Spacing Consistency	6.5/10	Some pages have inconsistent padding — settings page feels cramped
Dark Theme Completeness	7.0/10	Most UI dark; some native file dialogs and modals break dark theme
Icon System	7.0/10	Lucide icons are clean; missing custom icons for AI model types
Empty States	3.0/10	No empty state illustrations — blank pages feel unfinished
Animation & Motion	6.0/10	Framer Motion used in landing page; canvas lacks transition polish
Canvas Node Design	8.0/10	240×320px cards with red connectors are distinctive — best part of UI
Loading States	4.5/10	Generic spinners; no skeleton loaders; no micro-animations
Responsive Layout	7.0/10	Desktop-first correctly — no mobile needed; sidebar collapses well

8. Accessibility Audit

Accessibility is not a primary concern for a professional desktop tool in its pre-release phase, but several basic accessibility issues affect usability for all users (not just those with disabilities). The most impactful quick wins are keyboard navigation, focus indicators, and ARIA labels.

Issue	Priority	Current State	Fix
Keyboard Navigation	HIGH	Canvas not fully keyboard navigable — mouse required for all node operations	Add Tab-focus to nodes; Space to select; arrow keys to move
Focus Indicators	MEDIUM	Focus ring removed (outline:none) on some interactive elements	Restore :focus-visible ring — red outline matches brand color
ARIA Labels	MEDIUM	Icon buttons lack aria-label — screen readers read 'button' only	Add aria-label to all icon buttons: aria-label='Add source node'
Color Contrast	MEDIUM	Some TEXT_GRAY (#AAAAAA) on dark background fails WCAG AA	Use #BBBBBB minimum for body text on dark backgrounds
Image Alt Text	LOW	Generated images in canvas have no alt text	Use prompt text as alt: alt={node.prompt.substring(0,100)}
Error Announcements	MEDIUM	Toast notifications not announced to screen readers	Add role='alert' aria-live='polite' to toast container

9. Top UX Improvements

Ranked by user impact — 40 improvements to reach UX score of 9.0

Tier 1 — Critical (Do First, Highest Impact)

01. Real generation progress (API steps, not fake timer) — highest trust impact
02. Cancel generation button — removes the most frustrating user moment
03. Actionable error messages with specific cause + suggested fix
04. History: add 'Load in Canvas' button — closes the biggest workflow gap
05. History: implement virtual scroll pagination — prevents crash on power users
06. Onboarding: Quick Start sample project on first launch
07. Disable Generate button during active job — prevent double-submit confusion
08. Node palette (Tab key) — makes GhostNode types discoverable

Tier 2 — High Impact (Do in Sprint 2-3)

01. Global Cmd+K search palette across history + library + canvas
02. Canvas minimap (M key toggle) for large workflows
03. Canvas workflow templates (3 starter layouts)
04. Library: add Collections / project folders
05. Notification deduplication with count badges
06. Notification history bell icon in header
07. Keyboard shortcuts: Ctrl+Z, Ctrl+Enter, Ctrl+D, Space+drag
08. Shortcut reference overlay (? key)
09. Empty state illustrations for History, Library, Projects pages
10. Contextual help '?' tooltips on every major feature

Tier 3 — Polish (Sprint 4+)

01. Skeleton loaders for History and Library instead of spinners
02. Success toast with thumbnail preview of generated image
03. Canvas node grouping with colored frame
04. Auto-layout (arrange nodes by data flow direction)
05. Bridge connection status indicator in toolbar
06. Add API key setup wizard for new users
07. Search: highlight matched text in results
08. Library: drag-from-library to canvas as source node

- 09. Export filename uses project name instead of timestamp
- 10. Side-by-side comparison view for upscale (before/after slider)

End of File 6 / 8

This concludes the UX Audit. Continue with **File 7 — Top 50 Problems + Top 100 Improvements** for the complete prioritized issue registry and comprehensive improvement backlog covering all audit categories.